

ple windows. The user can customise the browser with downloadable extensions, a variety of themes and skins, and many preferences (for the advanced user).

Firefox uses SSL/TLS to protect communications with Web servers using strong cryptography. It also supports smart cards for secure login to Web servers. Firefox is considered by many to be safer than Microsoft's Internet Explorer.

How To Use It

Firefox comes with a number of excellent features and extensions.

1. The most useful feature is probably tabbed browsing. It enables the user to open multiple Web pages at the same time in a single browser window. There is also the group bookmarking feature, which enables all bookmarked tabs to be re-opened at one time.

To open a new tab, right-click on a link and select "Open Link in New Tab". Or, type in [Ctrl] + [T]. To customise tabs, on the Menu Toolbar, select **Edit > Preferences > Navigator > Tabbed Browsing**, and then choose your preferred settings.

2. The sidebar is a re-sizeable vertical panel at the left of the browser window. It may contain numerous tabs that you click on to reveal different content in the sidebar panel. It can be customised to add frequently-used items.

Standard sidebars in Mozilla include bookmarks, search, and history. Sidebars provide a very handy way to access these functions. And, with tabbed browsing, the user can middle-click a sidebar link and open it in a new tab rather than overwriting the existing browser window.

3. Themes give Firefox a look suited to the user's personal preferences. The theme selection determines the style of the browser menus, buttons, and other features. The user can obtain new and classic themes from the following sites: